

Module 13: Cities, Communities, and Integration

Signature Learning Experience

Purpose

Teams design a realistic community-based intervention that improves integration in a specific city or neighborhood — housing, education, services, or belonging. The emphasis is on community-led design: interventions that work with existing community assets rather than parachuting in.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Explain the integration challenge in a specific place with evidence (UG 1)
- Identify the support systems already operating there (UG 2)
- Describe the role of communities — including refugee-led organizations — in the design (UG 3)
- Recognize how policy constraints shape what is possible locally (UG 4)

Graduate extension

Graduate students evaluate an existing integration model from another city as a design input (what does the evidence say about it?), and add a logic model with indicators and an evaluation plan to the intervention (Grad 1–2).

Assignment steps

1. Choose a real place — ideally your own city or one a team member knows — and one integration domain: housing access, school transition, service navigation, civic belonging, economic entry.
2. Map what already exists: formal services and community-led assets (mutual aid, congregations, diaspora associations). Build on the strongest asset you find.
3. Define the gap precisely: who falls through, at what moment, and why — evidence from local reporting, service data, or (where feasible) conversation with a local organization.
4. Design the intervention: what it does, who leads it (community role must be genuine, not decorative), what it costs roughly, and what policy constraints it must live within.
5. Anticipate failure: name the two most likely ways this design fails and what you would watch for.
6. Present as a team to the class; submit the written design individually or as a team per instructor's direction.

Deliverables & format

- Intervention design, 2,000–2,500 words with a one-page visual summary (graduate adds model evaluation and logic model)
- Community asset map for the chosen place
- Presentation materials

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Specificity of the local gap analysis 25%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: specificity of the local gap analysis goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: specificity of the local gap analysis is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: specificity of the local gap analysis is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: specificity of the local gap analysis is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Genuine community-led design — assets built on, leadership placed locally 30%	Collaboration is genuinely shared: genuine community-led design — assets built on, leadership placed locally is fully realized — partner and community voices shaped key decisions, their priorities are visible in the result, and their contribution is credited.	Collaboration is real: genuine community-led design — assets built on, leadership placed locally is achieved — the partner reviewed and influenced the work, though some decisions stayed one-sided.	Collaboration is thin: genuine community-led design — assets built on, leadership placed locally is claimed more than practiced; the partner was consulted late or superficially, and the result reflects the student's assumptions.	Collaboration is absent: genuine community-led design — assets built on, leadership placed locally did not occur; the work was done about or for the community rather than with it.
Feasibility: costs, constraints, failure modes 25%	Design judgment is excellent: feasibility: costs, constraints, failure modes is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: feasibility: costs, constraints, failure modes is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: feasibility: costs, constraints, failure modes is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: feasibility: costs, constraints, failure modes is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Presentation and written clarity 20%	Communication is publication-ready: presentation and written clarity is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: presentation and written clarity is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: presentation and written clarity is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: presentation and written clarity is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.